Day 2 - Leverage Your Community.

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“One of the marvelous things about community is that it enables us to welcome and help people in a way we couldn’t as individuals.” -Jean Vanier

When the west was being built, the concept of community building was widely practiced. Barn raisings and harvest help were the way of life because they realized they couldn’t do it all on their own. “Many hands make light work” is just as true today as it was back then. Trying to increase your profitability through agritourism will become easier and better if you involve your community to be apart of the efforts.

Does your local community know what you do on your property? For example, do they know you grow organic produce or have a pumpkin patch where they can buy and pick their own pumpkins?

Here are five ways to start networking with your local community to increase awareness of your agritourism business:

1. Network with Local Businesses - Contact your local chamber of commerce and ask what resources they provide for networking among your community. Ask how your business can be listed and cross-promoted within the community. Provide coupons or fliers to businesses and organizations that might promote you. Your local community can become a backbone of support for your business. By networking with your community, you offer visitors the best that your community has to offer.

2. Affiliate Program- Consider offering an affiliate program paying a commission to others referring business to you.

3. Cross-Promote- Talk with your neighbors to see what services or goods they are producing that you could cross-promote or sell to your customers. Does a neighbor make specialized soap or honey that would be a delight for your customers? How can you incorporate that for your customers? Work out a percentage of sales so you and your neighbors can make a profit on the sale.

4. Student Tours- Contact your local school district and see what programs they have for teaching students about farm life or whatever is your particular agritourism specialty. Learn what it would take to include your business on school field trips. Getting children to your business will bring adults, which increases awareness of your business. Plus, school field trips can happen annually which gives you a recurring transaction each year. If you have multiple different agritourism offerings, you may be able to get different groups of students at different times of year to come and participate in your business.

5. Partner- See what local businesses align with your business that you could work together to provide a better service together for your customers. For example, do you know of a neighbor who is amazing at finding the best fishing spots or spotting for hunting? Would he offer guiding services to your customers? You can take a small fee for marketing his services and you offer your customers amazing opportunities to explore. You could do this for fishing, hunting, hiking, mountain biking, making artisan food or crafts, etc.

Bonus. Host Events - Host a community gathering like a Farmer’s Market or Fall Festival. Involve as many community members as possible to strengthen your community network and share the load of the event. This is a great way to get more bodies to your business and let them experience firsthand the amazing opportunity you have created at your property.

What will you do today to network with your community? _____

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Today's Action

Create a written plan of action today of how you are going to work with your community to grow your agritourism business.

Tomorrow: Day 3

Tomorrow's lesson will teach how you can tap into local, county, state, and federal programs to help improve, preserve and market your property.

This course is brought to you by CurbNTurf, a service kind of like AirBNB, but we connect agritourism businesses and other property owners with RVers who need a place to stay while they're traveling. CurbNTurf can help bring more customers to your agritourism business, plus help you generate new income streams as the RVers pay to stay on your property. To learn more about listing your property for free on CurbNTurf, please visit: https://www.curbnturf.com/host. Or you can call us at (800) 877-5005 with an questions. We can also help you get the CurbNTurf listing for your property set up.

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